UPSC Civil Services Mains — Anthropology Optional Paper II

Anthropology of India

Syllabus outline for focused preparation

2.1 Evolution of Indian Culture and Civilization

• Prehistoric (Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic and Neolithic-Chalcolithic); Protohistoric (Indus Civilization).

• Prehistoric and Protohistoric cultures of India; Palaeo-anthropological evidence from India with special reference to Siwaliks and Narmada basin.

2.2 Demographic Profile of India

• Ethnic and linguistic elements in the Indian population and their distribution.

• Indian population—factors influencing its structure and growth.

2.3 Caste System in India

• Varna and caste; theories of origin of caste system; dominant caste; caste mobility; issues of untouchability; social change and caste; caste and politics.

2.4.1 Indian Village

• Significance of village study in India; Indian village as a social system; traditional and changing patterns of settlement and inter-caste relations; agrarian relations; impact of globalization on Indian villages.

2.4.2 Linguistic and Religious Minorities

• Linguistic and religious minorities and their social, political and economic status.

2.4.3 Tribal Situation in India

• Biogenetic variability; linguistic and socio-economic characteristics of tribal populations and their distribution; problems of tribal communities.

2.5.1 Problems of Tribal Communities

• Developmental projects and their impact on tribal displacement and problems of rehabilitation; forest policy and tribals; impact of urbanization and industrialization on tribal and rural populations.

2.5.2 Social Change in India

• Development of Indian civilization; nature of traditional Indian social system; Indian social system in the context of modernisation.

2.6.1 Tribal Administration and Development

• History of tribal administration; tribal policies, plans, programmes of tribal development and their implementation; role of NGOs.

2.6.2 Social Change and Contemporary Tribal Societies

• Impact of Hinduism, Buddhism, Christianity, Islam and other religions on tribal societies; impact of globalization and media; political and economic changes in tribal societies.

2.7.1 Ethnicity and Tribal Movements

• Ethnicity and tribal movements; regionalism and autonomy; pseudo-tribalism; ethnic conflicts.

2.7.2 Ethnicity and Nation Building

• Impact of ethnicity in nation building.

2.8.1 Constitutional Safeguards for Scheduled Tribes

• Scheduled Tribes and the Indian Constitution; constitutional safeguards for Scheduled Tribes.

2.8.2 Religious and Linguistic Minorities

• Social, political and economic status of religious and linguistic minorities.

2.8.3 Social Change and Development

• Social change and development among tribal communities; impact of development programmes; role of the state, NGOs and other institutions.

2.9.1 Tribal and Rural Development

• Tribal and rural development programmes and their implementation; role of administrators and planners.

2.9.2 Anthropology in Development

• Contribution of anthropology to the understanding of regionalism, communalism, ethnic and political movements.

Reference: UPSC Civil Services (Main) Examination syllabus. Verify against the latest official UPSC notification for any amendments.